SWIM

Week 01 Swim

Week 1 of 52 | Mon 05 Oct 2026 to Sun 11 Oct 2026 | Month 1: Foundation and testing

Tuesday, 06 Oct Swim A - Body position (50 min)

Focus: Balance, long body line, hips at the surface

Section	Details
Warm-up	200 easy FS, 100 kick with board
Drills	4 x 50 Kick on side (25 each side) r20 4 x 50 6-3-6 r20 4 x 50 Catch-up r20
Main set	6 x 100 FS easy r30. Focus: head down, hips up, long reach. Count strokes on the last 25 of each 100 and write it down.
Cool-down	100 easy choice

Total: about 1500 m
Notes: This is a technique session. If you finish with your usual stroke count and feel long and relaxed, it worked.

Friday, 09 Oct Swim B - 400 m baseline time trial (50 min)

Focus: Establish the swim pace the next 8 weeks are built on

Section	Details
Warm-up	200 easy FS, 100 kick with board, 4 x 50 Build r20
Test	400 m FS time trial from a push. Even pace, strong but controlled. Record total time and your per-100 average. Expected: around 8:00 (2:00/100). Write the time on this sheet.
Recovery	200 very easy, mix of backstroke and FS
Drills	4 x 50 (25 Fist drill / 25 FS) r20 4 x 50 (25 Fingertip drag / 25 FS) r20
Cool-down	100 easy

Total: about 1500 m
Notes: 400 m time _____ Per-100 average _____ Training pace for Month 1 = 400 pace + 10 s per 100.

Drill cue cards for this week

Drill	How to do it and what it trains
Kick with board	Board held at arm's length, face in the water, exhale, breathe forward or to the side. Kick comes from the hips with a soft knee, toes pointed, ankles loose. Small and fast beats big and slow. Purpose: leg endurance and ankle flexibility.
Kick on side	One arm extended in front, palm down, other arm on your hip. Ear rests on the extended arm, body rolled about 45 degrees, hips at the surface. Kick steadily; rotate the head to breathe without lifting it. Switch sides every 25. Purpose: balance and body line.
6-3-6	Six kicks on one side (as in Kick on side), three full strokes, six kicks on the other side. Keep the hips high and the extended arm still while kicking. Purpose: rotation, balance, and timing the arm switch with the hips.
Catch-up	Both arms start extended. One arm pulls and recovers while the other waits out front; the recovering hand touches the waiting hand before the next stroke starts. Purpose: long stroke, front-quadrant timing, patience in the glide.

Drill	How to do it and what it trains
Stroke count	Count strokes per 25 m (one arm = one stroke). Write down your normal count, then try to hold pace with one fewer. Purpose: efficiency and distance per stroke.
Build 50	Start the 50 easy and finish it fast, without letting the stroke shorten. Purpose: learning to raise speed by pressing harder on the water, not by spinning the arms.
Fist drill	Swim freestyle with closed fists. You will feel the forearm doing the work. After 25 m of fists open the hands and notice the extra grip. Purpose: early vertical forearm and feel for the water.
Fingertip drag	Swim normally but during the recovery let the fingertips trail along the surface, elbow high and pointing to the ceiling. Purpose: relaxed, high-elbow recovery and shoulder rotation.